

AI Introduction — Assignment 1

Discovering Work That an AI Agent Could Do

Prepare a portfolio of several pieces of work that an AI agent could potentially do for you.

Type: Individual report

Length: 3–5 A4 pages, including tables

Language: English

Number of Agent opportunities: 4–6

You may discuss ideas with classmates, but the submitted work must be your own. You may use AI to polish your wording. However, the choice of work and the workflow design must be yours.

AI-use disclosure

In an appendix, state:

- which AI tool you used;
- what you asked it to do;
- which parts of its output you retained;
- what you checked, rejected, or changed yourself.

The disclosure and full prompts do not count toward the page limit.

Do not give an AI tool passwords, student ID numbers, unpublished grades, confidential company information, client lists, medical records, or another person's private information.

The question

Identify **4–6 pieces of work** from your study, employment, research, student society, or daily life that an AI agent could potentially do for you.

For each piece of work, explain:

1. what finished result you want;
2. how you currently do the work and what makes it time-consuming, repetitive, or difficult;
3. what the Agent would observe or receive;
4. what actions the Agent would take;
5. what tools, access, or information it would need;
6. what the Agent would produce and where a human would participate.

The purpose of this assignment is to discover possibilities and make them concrete. You are **not** expected to test the Agent or decide whether each idea is valuable, feasible, risky, or suitable at this stage.

What counts as a piece of work?

A piece of work must produce a concrete result that another person could inspect or use.

- **Acceptable:** "Turn six sets of meeting notes into a list of action items, identify missing owners, and prepare a draft message for the group."

- **Acceptable:** “Monitor three university webpages for scholarship updates and prepare a weekly summary of changes.”
- **Not acceptable:** “Help me study better.”
- **Not acceptable:** “Do my work for me.”

An Agent does more than produce one reply. It may observe information, plan several steps, use tools, take actions, check results, and adjust what it does. A fluent explanation does not prove that an action was completed successfully.

Required sections

1. My work context

Briefly describe your major, role, or typical responsibilities. Explain what kinds of work take your time during a normal week.

Do not include private or confidential information.

2. Work inventory

List **8–10 pieces of work** that you currently do. These can be frequent, slow, repetitive, difficult, or easy to forget.

Work I currently do	Current method	Approximate time or difficulty	Possible role for an Agent

From this inventory, select **4–6 Agent opportunities** for the rest of the report. Try to include different kinds of work, rather than six versions of the same task.

Your selected work should include at least three of the following:

- finding, monitoring, or organising information;
- creating, rewriting, translating, or communicating content;
- planning or coordinating several steps;
- using a digital tool or acting in an environment;
- checking work and identifying problems.

3. Agent opportunities

Complete one row for each of your 4–6 selected pieces of work.

Work	Current difficulty	Intended result	What the Agent observes or receives	What the Agent does	Tools or access needed	Human participation

Be specific about actions. Avoid descriptions such as “AI helps me” or “AI makes it better.”

4. Workflow sketches

For **each selected piece of work**, give a short workflow of **3–5 steps**. You may use a separate table for each piece of work.

Work: _____

Step	Agent action	Human action or check	Input	Output
1				
2				
3				

Across your workflows, you must include:

- at least one step where the Agent drafts, organises, or suggests options but **does not make the final decision**;
- at least one human check or sign-off;
- the materials that the Agent would need;
- at least one way of confirming that an action really happened, rather than trusting the Agent’s description.

5. Reflection

Answer the following questions:

1. What kinds of work did you notice only after making your work inventory?
2. Where is the difference between an Agent and an ordinary chatbot most visible?
3. In your proposed workflows, what would the Agent do and where would a human participate?
4. Which possible use of an Agent surprised you most?
5. What patterns do you see across the 4–6 opportunities you identified?